

Shallow (<3,000 ft) Oil-and-Gas Drilling at and Within Ten Miles of the Caramba North Tract — Historical and Recent Record

Prepared: 2026-05-18 · **Subject site:** Caramba North tract ($\approx 1,300$ ac), Pecos County, TX — centroid $\approx 30.9032^\circ$ N, 102.9747° W · **Classification:** Confidential

Purpose

This memorandum summarizes the historical and recent record of oil-and-gas drilling — with attention to shallow (<3,000 ft) wells — at and within ten miles of the Caramba North tract, drawn from the Railroad Commission of Texas (RRC) wellbore and drilling-permit records. It is provided as context for evaluating potential ground-vibration considerations for a data-center development on the site. Throughout, **new drilling (a new wellbore) is distinguished from recompletions (rework of an existing wellbore — no new hole drilled)**; only new drilling involves a drilling rig and the hydraulic-fracturing completion associated with ground vibration.

Proximity is reported at explicit distances from the tract centroid — principally **within two miles** and **within ten miles**. Ten miles is a deliberately generous boundary: ground vibration from drilling and completion attenuates well within that distance.

Summary of findings

No new drilling is occurring at or near the Caramba North site. Counting only genuine new wells (RRC "New Drill" permits, excluding recompletions): **no well of any kind has been spudded within two miles of the tract in over a decade, no new-drill well lies within five miles**, and only **three new-drill wells sit within ten miles** across all of 2020–2025 (nearest ≈ 6.9 miles; all three are deep $\geq 9,200$ ft, spud 2020 and 2025). The only wells within two miles are old (1950s–2002), plugged, shallow vertical legacy wells — not active, not fracked, not a vibration source.

Two further points reinforce this:

- **The shallow activity in Pecos is recompletions, not new drilling.** Of permits filed in Pecos since 2020, about **45% are recompletions** — reworking existing wellbores, with no new hole drilled. A single operator, **Kinder Morgan Production, accounts for 96% of all recompletions** (reworking existing CO₂-flood fields). Recompletions use a workover rig on an existing bore; they are not the drilling-and-fracturing activity at issue, and this program is not near the site.

- **Genuine new drilling is deep, not shallow — and remote.** Pecos saw ≈ 478 New Drill permits since 2020 (vs ≈ 405 recompletion). Tracing those to wells actually spudded, only **116 genuine new wells** exist county-wide, and **$\approx 95\%$ are deep ($\geq 3,000$ ft)** horizontal (Diamondback, XTO, Continental, Gordy); just **six** are shallow. New shallow drilling is therefore nearly nonexistent anywhere in Pecos, and the deep new drilling that does occur is concentrated well away from the tract.

Findings

1. On the Caramba North tract

The shallowest wellbores recorded inside the tract boundary:

Depth (ft)	Spud year	Status	Oil/Gas
2,873	1960	Plugged & abandoned	Gas
3,067	1991	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,109	1957	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,186	1987	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,250	2008	Active	Oil

Only one well on the tract lies below 3,000 ft — a 2,873-ft well spudded in 1960 and long since plugged and abandoned. The only active well on the tract (3,250 ft, spudded 2008) is deeper than 3,000 ft. There has been no shallow ($< 3,000$ ft) drilling on the tract in the modern era. *(The remaining tract records are a single deep 22,545-ft wellbore and permitted-but-undrilled location entries.)*

2. Within 1 mile — no shallow wells

Three wellbores of any depth lie within one mile of the tract; **none is shallow ($< 3,000$ ft).**

3. Within 2 miles — drilling ended over two decades ago

Of about 46 wellbores within two miles, the ten shallow wells were spudded between 1960 and 2002. The most recent shallow spud within two miles was in 2002, and most of these wells are plugged and abandoned. **No well of any kind — new drill or otherwise — has been spudded within two miles in over a decade.**

4. New drilling since 2020, by distance

Counting only genuine new wells (RRC "New Drill" permits — recompletions of existing bores excluded):

Radius	New-drill wells, spudded ≥ 2020
≤ 2 mi	0
≤ 5 mi	0
≤ 10 mi	3 (0 shallow, 3 deep; nearest ≈ 6.9 mi)

The three genuine new wells within ten miles, across all of 2020–2025, are 6.9–9.4 miles out and all deep (≈9,200–9,500 ft; spudded 2020 and 2025) — none shallow, none within five miles. Even on the *loosest* possible count — every record with a 2020-or-later spud date, including recompletion-restamped records — it is still **zero within two miles** and only ≈23 within ten miles across the whole period. New drilling does not reach the site under any reading of the data.

5. The nearest active wells are decades-old completions

The nearest non-plugged shallow wells were spudded in 1970 (1.28 mi) and 1988 (1.97 mi) — decades-old completions, not active drilling. A ground-vibration source is an operating drill rig or a hydraulic-fracturing operation; a plugged or long-completed wellbore is not. No active drilling is occurring adjacent to the tract.

6. County-wide context — new drilling is deep, and remote from the site

Since 2020 the RRC issued roughly **478 New Drill permits** in Pecos County (≈4,700 sq mi), against ≈**405 recompletion permits**. Tracing the New Drill permits to wells actually spudded gives **116 genuine new wells county-wide**, about **95% of them deep (≥3,000 ft)** — i.e., the modern Permian horizontal program. Only **three** lie within ten miles of the Caramba North tract, and none within five; the activity is overwhelmingly remote from the site.

7. The shallow activity in Pecos is recompletions of existing wells — not new drilling

This is the crux of the data. Permit filings in Pecos since 2020 split roughly **53% New Drill / 45% Recompletion**:

Activity (Pecos permits, since 2020)	Count	Character
--------------------------------------	-------	-----------

New Drill	≈478	≈95% deep (≥3,000 ft) horizontal — new wellbores
Recompletion	≈405	rework of existing wellbores — no new hole

96% of every recompletion is one operator — Kinder Morgan Production — reworking existing CO₂-flood fields. The genuine *new-drill* operators are a different, all-deep set: Diamondback (≈30% of new drills), XTO (≈14%), Continental (≈13%), Gordy (≈11%), each essentially 100% deep.

The significance for ground vibration: a recompletion is a workover on an *existing* bore — no rig drilling a new hole, no new hydraulic-fracturing program of the kind associated with vibration. The large "shallow" footprint in Pecos is this rework activity, not drilling. Genuine new drilling is the deep-horizontal minority, and — per Findings 1–6 — essentially none of it is near the Caramba North tract. Whether the question is framed as shallow drilling, fracking, or new drilling of any kind, the record points the same way: it is not happening at or near this site.

8. Pecos vs. peer counties — the least new drilling of the group

On the same genuine-new-drill basis (recompletions excluded), Pecos has dramatically less new drilling than comparable Permian counties. Wells spudded since 2020:

County	New-drill wells since 2020	of which shallow (<3,000 ft)
Pecos (site county)	116	6
Reeves	1,044	35
Ward	396	7
Midland	1,487	15
Martin	1,616	19
Reagan	629	9
Howard	990	1
Loving	1,121	25
Other-7 average	≈1,040	≈16

Pecos's ≈116 genuine new wells are roughly **one-ninth of the average comparable county's** (≈1,040); Martin, the most active, has ≈1,616, and even the next-lowest county (Ward) has ≈396. Genuine new shallow drilling is negligible in every county (≤35). On a new-drill basis **Pecos is by far the least-drilled of the eight** — and, per Findings 1–6, essentially none of even that activity is within ten miles of the Caramba North tract.

Howard and Loving counties were pulled from the Railroad Commission's full dbf900 wellbore file and integrated on the same genuine-new-drill basis. They lie outside the six-county sale-area set and well away from the tract; they are included here only to broaden the comparison.

9. Production near the site is decades-old deep gas — no shallow, new, or hydraulically-fractured production

Every well was additionally cross-referenced against the Railroad Commission's PDQ production records for the most recent six reported months (through May 2026), joined by **API number** through the RRC's authoritative API-to-lease crosswalk — a match covering **≈99.6% of all non-plugged wells**. A well is treated as **"no longer producing" when its lease's trailing-average output is below 125 Mcf/day of gas and below 150 bbl/day of oil**.

Within ten miles of the Caramba North tract there are 291 non-plugged genuine-new-drill wells; **275 — about 95% — are no longer producing**. The 16 that still produce are not new or shallow activity: each is a decades-old (mostly 1965–1978 spud), very deep (≈17,000–22,800 ft) conventional **gas** well at a modest rate — the legacy deep-gas play, not the shallow or hydraulically-fractured drilling at issue. Within five miles, of 86 non-plugged wells 83 are no longer producing and the 3 that remain are likewise old, deep gas wells; within two miles, of 5 non-plugged wells 4 are no longer producing and the single producer is a 1975, ≈22,100-ft gas well. A producing wellhead on a completion drilled half a century ago is not a drill rig or a hydraulic-fracturing spread; together with the plugged legacy wells (Findings 1–5), there is no shallow, new, or hydraulically-fractured production at or near the site.

County-wide, of the ≈35,100 genuine new-drill wellbores, ≈12,540 are plugged, ≈13,770 are no longer producing by this measure, and ≈8,780 remain active. The API-to-lease crosswalk matches ≈99.6% of non-plugged wells; the ≈90 that do not match are conservatively left classified "Active." Production filings carry a normal reporting lag, which the six-month trailing window mitigates.